

Below is the complete, sequential set of prompts—including the new “Skills” section—to guide workshop participants step by step in recreating the portfolio website.

1. Base Structure & HTML Skeleton

Prompt:

“Create a new HTML file that sets up the basic structure of a portfolio website for a software engineer. Use semantic HTML tags (header, main, footer) and include placeholder comments for each section hero, about, skills, timeline, projects, etc. Also, include a placeholder for a night mode toggle.”

2. Hero Section with Pixel Art & Night Mode Toggle

Prompt:

“Develop the hero section at the top of the page. Use CSS to implement a pixel art style design and add a background image that I have provided. Incorporate a night mode toggle that uses CSS media queries to detect the user’s default browser theme. Ensure the section welcomes visitors with a title and a brief tagline.

3. Vertical Navigation Bar

Prompt:

“Design a vertical navigation bar that will be placed on the left side of the screen. Include links for ‘Home’, ‘About Me’, ‘Skills’, ‘Timeline’, ‘Projects’, ‘Testimonials’, ‘Chat’, and ‘Contact’. Style the navbar using CSS so that it stands out while complementing the pixel art aesthetic, and ensure it’s accessible and responsive.”

4. About Me Section with Profile & Bio

Prompt:

“Build the ‘About Me’ section. Insert a profile image (you may use a pixel-art avatar) and write a short bio describing the software engineer. Use a clean, minimalist design and include a brief introduction about career highlights or personal interests.”

5. Skills Section

Prompt:

“Develop a ‘Skills’ section that highlights the software engineer’s core competencies. Create a visually engaging layout that lists key skills—such as programming languages, frameworks, and tools—using progress bars, icons, or styled lists. Ensure that the section maintains the pixel art aesthetic and overall design consistency. Include brief comments in your code to explain how each element represents a specific skill, and consider adding subtle animations or hover effects to enhance interactivity.”

6. Interactive Timeline of Career Milestones

Prompt:

“Create a timeline component beneath the ‘Skills’ section. This timeline should list key events (education, major projects, career milestones) in a visually engaging manner. Use rounded boxes or cards and CSS transitions to add a smooth hover effect. Keep the design minimalistic and coherent with the overall theme.”

7. Projects Section with Clickable Thumbnails

Prompt:

“Develop a ‘Projects’ section that displays several project thumbnails. Each thumbnail should be clickable and open a detailed view or link to the project. Style the thumbnails with consistent margins, padding, and hover effects. Add comments in your code to explain how each thumbnail is connected to its project detail.”

8. Embedded YouTube Video Section

Prompt:

“Embed a YouTube video in a dedicated section to serve as a portfolio highlight or an introduction. Ensure the video is responsive (using CSS techniques like aspect-ratio or a container with padding) and fits well with the pixel art style. Include a short caption explaining the video’s content.”

9. Testimonials Section

Prompt:

“Add a ‘Testimonials’ section where quotes or feedback from clients and peers are displayed. Each testimonial should be inside a card-like container with a subtle drop shadow and rounded corners. Style the text and layout so that it remains clean and readable, matching the overall design.”

10. AI Chat Interface Integration

Prompt:

“Implement a chat section that allows visitors to interact with an AI version of the portfolio owner. Create a chat window interface with an input field and a display area for messages. Include basic JavaScript to simulate sending/receiving messages, and leave comments indicating where an API (like OpenAI) could be integrated later.”

11. Contact Form with Email API Functionality

Prompt:

“Develop a contact form in its own section. The form should include fields for name, email, and a message. Style the form so that the submit button is clearly visible (ensure proper contrast with the background). Add a comment in the code where integration with an email-sending service (such as Resend API) should occur, and include a confirmation message upon successful submission.”

12. Social Media Links in the Footer

Prompt:

“Design a footer that includes social media icons linking to relevant profiles. Ensure the icons adhere to the pixel art aesthetic and are evenly spaced. Add hover effects and proper accessibility features (like aria labels or alt text) for each icon.”

13. Responsive Design & Layout Adjustments

Prompt:

“Apply responsive design principles to ensure the website looks great on all devices. Use CSS media queries to adjust layout, spacing, and font sizes for mobile, tablet, and desktop views. Test and fine-tune the vertical navbar, grid layouts for sections, and overall margins/padding.”

14. Visual Enhancements & Finishing Touches

Prompt:

“Enhance the UI by adding subtle animations and visual effects:

- Apply background blur effects or parallax transitions where appropriate.
- Use drop shadows and rounded corners consistently across cards and buttons.
- Add hover transitions to navigation items and interactive elements.

Comment your CSS to explain the purpose of each effect.”

15. Final Testing, Debugging, and Publishing

Prompt:

“Review the entire website by testing all components (navigation, chat interface, contact form, video embed, etc.) in different browsers and screen sizes. Debug any layout or functionality issues. Once satisfied, prepare the website for deployment (e.g., using GitHub Pages or another hosting solution) and document the deployment steps.”

Using these 15 layered prompts in sequence will guide participants through the creation of the complete portfolio website—starting with a basic structure and gradually adding more complex, interactive features and visual enhancements.